

Ruth's Loyalty: Love That Crosses Boundaries

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Ages 10-17

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories - Book 47 of 60

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Scene 1

[PICTURE: A family of four — father Elimelech, mother Naomi, and two teenage sons — walking away from the gates of Bethlehem with bundles on their backs. The fields behind them are dry and barren. Naomi looks back with sadness while her husband leads them forward with determination. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Famine gripped the land of Judah like a slow, choking death. The fields that once overflowed with grain lay cracked and barren. Elimelech, a man from Bethlehem — whose name ironically means "my God is King" — made a fateful decision: he would take his wife Naomi and their two sons, Mahlon and Chilion, and emigrate to Moab, a foreign land with foreign gods. It was a desperate choice born of survival, yet it meant leaving behind the community of faith, the promises of God, and the land of their inheritance.

[illegible]

(Timet nimidri Yihuda kem zizihhil mot zeniqete hazo. Itom hade gize bi'ikhli ziiwihizu zineberu grawthi tesenitiqom terizom terekhibu. Elimelekh hade nay Betlehem seb'ay — simu bizegirim "Amlakey nigus'yu" zibil tirigum zilewo — itscha ziwsin wisane wesene; sebey'tu Na'omi'n kilte dequ Mahhlon'n Kiliyon'n hizu nab Mo'ab ba'idawit midri mis ba'idawiyen amalkhti kisedid. Kab dihhinet zitewelde tesfa ziqoretse mircha nebere gin mahbereseb imnet, tesfatat Amlak'n nay wirsha midrom'n migdaf malet nebere.)

Scene 3

[PICTURE: Two burial scenes shown side by side — Naomi now completely alone, kneeling at two graves in Moabite soil. Orpah and Ruth stand on either side of her, supporting the devastated older woman. The landscape is bleak and empty. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Then both Mahlon and Chilion died. In the span of a decade, Naomi lost everything — her husband, both sons, and with them, any hope of grandchildren, financial security, or social standing. In the ancient world, a childless widow was among the most vulnerable people in society. Naomi was not just grieving; she was destitute, stranded in a foreign country with no male protector, no income, and no future she could see. Sometimes life strips away everything, and we are left with nothing but God — and even He can feel distant.

[illegible]

(*Dihri'u Mahhlon'n Kilijon'n kiltom motu. Ab wishti asirte ametat Na'omi kulu si'anet — seb'aya, kilti'om deqa misom dima zikhone tesfa deqi deqi, genzebawi dihinnet wey mahberawi dereja. Ab tintawi alem qol'a zeyibla mebelet ab mahbereseb kab zibelitsu tetqa'iti sebat neberet. Na'omi tihazin tiray zeyikonet — ab ba'idawit hager bizey wed teba'itay halawi, bizey itot zir'e metsai bizzeyibla dikhyiti neberet. Hade hade gize hiwet kulu neger yiqinititelka bizey Amlak hanti'wun ayitirfeka — nisu'wun rihug koynu kismi'aka yikhil.*)

Scene 4

[PICTURE: Naomi standing at a crossroads, her face aged with grief but resolute. She gestures back toward Bethlehem in the distance. News has reached her — a traveler tells her that God has provided food in Judah again. A faint green glow appears on the distant horizon. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Word reached Naomi that the Lord had visited His people in Bethlehem — the famine was over, and bread had returned to the "house of bread." This news stirred something in Naomi's devastated heart. Despite her bitterness and grief, she decided to return home. It was not hope that drove her — it was simply the absence of any reason to stay. Sometimes we return to God not in triumph but in desperation, not with full hearts but with empty hands. And God welcomes us either way.

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(Igzi'abher nihizbu ab Betlehem kem zibetsihe — timet kem zitewede'a nab "bet khibisti" khibisti kem zitemeliise zena nab Na'omi betsihe. Izi zena ab zitesebere libi Na'omi gele neger qesqese. Wala'kwa miret'n hazin'n inte nebera nab gezaa kitimelis wesenet. Tesfa zeyikone'yu zidefeji'a — nikitseenih mikiniyat mis'an tiray'yu zinebere. Hade hade gize nab Amlak nimiles bi'awet zeyikone bitesfa miqurats, bimeli'u libi zeyikone bitiray id'yu. Amlak dima bikilti'u megedi yiqbelena.)

Scene 5

[PICTURE: Naomi on a dusty road, turning to face her two daughters-in-law. She holds their hands, tears streaming down her face, urging them to go back to their mothers' homes in Moab. Orpah and Ruth both weep and cling to her. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

As they set out on the road to Judah, Naomi stopped and turned to her daughters-in-law with a speech that reveals her broken heart: "Go back, each of you, to your mother's home. May the Lord show you kindness, as you have shown kindness to your dead husbands and to me. May the Lord grant that you find rest in the home of another husband." Naomi was releasing them from any obligation. She believed she had nothing left to offer — no sons for them to marry, no future, no hope. In her pain, she couldn't imagine that God still had plans unfolding.

[illegible]

(Nab Yihuda ab ziwesid megedi kibgesa kelewa Na'omi dew ila niseb'uten nab tsenni'en zitesebere liba zigelits zereba tezarebeten; "Temelisa nefsi wekefkin nab bet adekin kida. Igzi'abher kem'ti nizimutu seb'utkin'n ni'ay'n zigeberkinni lewhat yer'i'khin. Igzi'abher ab bet kal'e seb'ay irefti kitrekhibba yihabkin." Na'omi kab zikhone gideta tifetihen neberet. Kithiben ziterefa hanti'wun kem zeyibla amenet — zimir'awen awedat yelbun, metsai yelbon, tesfa yelbon. Ab qanzaa Amlak gena zigelitsu medebat kem zilewwo kithassib ayke'aletin.)

Scene 6

[PICTURE: Orpah kissing Naomi goodbye with tears, then turning back toward Moab. In contrast, Ruth clings tightly to Naomi, refusing to let go. The road forks — one path leads back to Moab's familiar hills, the other stretches toward unknown Judah. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Both women wept and insisted on going with Naomi. But Naomi pressed them again — more firmly this time, with painful logic: "Return home. Why would you come with me? Am I going to have any more sons to become your husbands? I am too old. Even if I had a husband tonight and bore sons, would you wait until they grew up?" Orpah, with tears and a kiss, made the reasonable choice — she turned back to her people and her gods. No one could blame her. Ruth, however, clung to Naomi and would not let go. Two women, same circumstances, radically different choices.

[illegible]

(Kilti'an anisti bekeya mis Na'omi kikheda atsinni'en hateta. Gin Na'omi kem bihadish tseqetetien — hiji biziyaada bitsinu'e bizeqiniziw lojik, "Temelisa. Silemintay misay timetsaa? Seb'utkin kikhonu deqi kiwleduley'do'youm? Arige'ye. Wala lomi leyti seb'ay neyiruni awedat welide'kwa kisab zi'abiyu mitetsebkhinni'do'?" Orpa binib'at'n si'imet'h qinu'e mircha qeberet — nab hizba'n amalkhta'n temeliset. Manim kikhisesa

ayikhiln. Rut gin ab Na'omi tsenni'a hazet kitgedifa abeyet. Kilte anisti hade aynet kunetat biqetsali zitefelaleye mircha.)

Scene 7

[PICTURE: Ruth holding both of Naomi's hands, looking directly into her eyes with fierce determination and love. Her words seem to hang in the air between them like a sacred vow. The light behind Ruth creates a halo effect as she makes her declaration. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Then Ruth spoke words that have echoed through three thousand years of human history — words so powerful they are still recited at weddings today: "Don't urge me to leave you or to turn back from you. Where you go I will go, and where you stay I will stay. Your people will be my people and your God my God. Where you die I will die, and there I will be buried. May the Lord deal with me, be it ever so severely, if even death separates you and me." This was not romantic emotion — it was a covenant commitment. Ruth was choosing permanent exile from her homeland, her family, her gods, and her culture for the sake of love.

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(Dihri'u Rut ab seleste shih ametat tarikh deqi seb zidehabe qalat tezarebet — lomi'wun ab mer'a zinibeb kindawu zihaye qalat, "Kigdefikhi wey kimiles aytigdedni. Nabey mis kedkhi kikeyd'ye abey mis tsenakhki kitsinih'ye. Hizbikhi hizbey Amlakhkhi dima Amlakey kikhewn'yu. Abey mis motkhi kimewt'ye ab'u'wun kiqber'ye. Mot'wun inte zeyikone kabakhi zifelaleyyeni Igzi'abher kemu'n li'li'u'n yigbereni. "Izi

nay fiqri simi'it ayineberen — nay kidan qal kidan'yu zinebere. Rut mi'inti fiqri kab adaa, sidrabet, amalkhta'n bahlaa'n qewami sidet timrits neberet.)

Scene 8

[PICTURE: Ruth and Naomi walking together on a long dusty road toward Bethlehem. Ruth carries a bundle on her back and supports Naomi's arm. The road is harsh and uncertain, but Ruth's face shows unwavering resolve. Behind them, the land of Moab fades into the distance. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Consider the weight of Ruth's choice. She was a young Moabite widow choosing to accompany a bitter, elderly Israelite woman to a land where Moabites were despised — descendants of an incestuous origin story that made them permanent outsiders in Israelite society. Ruth would be a foreigner, a widow, and a member of a hated ethnic group. She had no guarantee of welcome, no promise of provision, no assurance that Naomi's God would accept her. She chose love without any safety net. This is what radical faithfulness looks like — it counts the cost and still says yes.

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(Nikibdet mircha Rut niseb. Nisa wala Mo'abawiyān ab mahbereseb Asra'el qewami
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nimkhad miret'n idme'n zelewa Asra'elawit sebeiti nimisnay zimiretset weytit
Mo'abawit mebelet neberet. Rut ba'idawit, mebelet nay zitsilae bhier abal kikhewn'ya.
Nay aqebabila wihisnet ayneberan, nay migibaz tesfa ayneberan, Amlak Na'omi kem

*ziqbela rigitsinet ayneberan. Bizey zikhone nay dihinnet tehalikha fiqri meretset. Sur-
neqel ta'amannet kemzi'yu zimisil — waga yiqotsir gin gena iwe yibil.)*

ayitemeselittin. Nab Amlak kitikeyd kelekha bisiqay nab Amlak kitteri'e zikhil aynet imnet alo. Miret Na'omi zeymhilaw imnet ayineberen — ab wishti rikib mis Amlak zitegeltse hazin'yu zinebere.)

Scene 10

[PICTURE: Ruth in a golden barley field at dawn, bent over gathering leftover grain stalks behind the harvesters. She works hard under the sun, sweat on her brow. Other poor gleaners work nearby. Her posture shows both humility and determination. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

They arrived at the beginning of barley harvest — God's timing, though neither woman could see it yet. Ruth immediately took initiative: "Let me go to the fields and pick up the leftover grain behind anyone in whose eyes I find favor." In Israelite law, landowners were commanded to leave grain at the edges of their fields for the poor, the foreigner, and the widow. Ruth was all three. She didn't wait for someone to rescue her — she found the humblest work available and threw herself into it. Faithfulness is not passive. It is showing up, doing the next right thing, even when you can't see the bigger picture.

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(Ab mejemertta nay sigem atsid'yom zibetsihu — gize Amlak wala'kwa kilti'an anisti gena kiri'iya'o zeyke'ala. Rut biqitsibet tebegiiso wesedet, "Nab grat keyde ab dihiri kulu ab aynu moges zirekhibelu ziterefe sigem ki'ariyo hidegini." Ab higi Asra'el wanatat midri nidikhaat niba'idawiyān'n nimebeletat'n ab chaf giratom sigem kigedifu te'azizom neberu. Rut selistiom neberet. Hade seb kedhina ayitetsebeyetin — zirikeb zitiyhute sirah rekhiba bimilu'e aqima atiya sirhhet. Ta'amannet telemamadi

*ayikonen. Mimitsai'e ziqitsil qinu'e neger migbar'yu wala abay si'ili kitri'i zeytkhil
kelekha.)*

Scene 11

[PICTURE: Boaz, a dignified wealthy landowner, arriving at his field and greeting his workers warmly. He notices Ruth working among the gleaners and asks his foreman about her. His expression shows interest and respect as he watches her tireless work. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

The text says Ruth "happened" to find herself working in the field belonging to Boaz — a wealthy, respected man from Elimelech's clan. But nothing in God's story truly "happens" by accident. When Boaz arrived and noticed Ruth, he asked his foreman, "Who does that young woman belong to?" The foreman reported her reputation: "She came back from Moab with Naomi. She asked permission to glean and has worked steadily from morning till now, with hardly a rest." Ruth's character — her work ethic, her humility, her loyalty — was already speaking for her before she ever said a word to Boaz.

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(Iti tsihuf Rut "bi'agatami" ab grat Bo'az — kab alet Elimelech zikhone habtam zikhber seb — tisrih minbara yinegir. Gin ab zanta Amlak bihaqi "bi'agatami" zikhewn neger yelbon. Bo'az mis metse niRut mis astebehale nihaleqa ayeytu hatetoo "iza weytit nay men'ya?" Iti haleqa biza'iba kibra negero, "Mis Na'omi kab Mo'ab zitemeliset'ya. Kiti'ari fiqad hatita kab nigihio kisab hiji bizey irefti bitsini'at siriha."

Bahri Rut — nay sirah tsihaf migbara, tihitinaa, ta'amannetaa — ni'Bo'az hanti qal qidmi mizraba diro biza'ibaa yizareb nebere.)

Scene 12

[PICTURE: Boaz approaching Ruth kindly in the field, offering her water from a jug. He speaks to her with respect and warmth. His workers look on. Ruth bows humbly, surprised by his generosity toward a foreigner. Golden barley surrounds them. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Boaz approached Ruth directly and spoke with remarkable kindness: "My daughter, listen to me. Don't go and glean in another field. Stay here with my servant girls. Watch the field where the men are harvesting, and follow along after them. I have told the men not to lay a hand on you. And whenever you are thirsty, go and get a drink from the water jars." Boaz didn't just notice Ruth — he actively protected her. In a world where foreign women were extremely vulnerable to exploitation and abuse, Boaz created safety around her. True kindness is not just emotional warmth; it is using your power to protect the vulnerable.

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(Bo'az biqetita nab Rut qeribu bizidniq lewhat tezareba, "Gwaley simi'ini. Nab kal'e grat keydkhi ayiti'arey. Ab'zi mis geredatey tsinhi. Iti seb'ut zi'atsidulu grat tekhatateliyen dihiri'en kid. Niseb'ut ayitinikifuwa ile azizeyom'ye. Mis tsema'ekhi kedkhi kab agani'om sitey." Bo'az niRut astebhilu tiray zeyikone — binit'i'fet tekelahelela. Ba'idawiyen anisti nimizimeza'n qifi'n aziyen teqaLatsi zikhonalu alem

*ab kebab'i'a dihinnet fetere. Haqenya lewhat simi'itawi miqirrab tiray ayikonen —
nitetqa'iti nimihilaw siltianka mitiq'am'yu.)*

Scene 13

[PICTURE: Ruth falling to her knees before Boaz, overwhelmed with gratitude. Her face shows genuine surprise and humility. She asks why he would show such kindness to a foreigner. Boaz stands with his hand extended in blessing, his expression warm and affirming. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Ruth fell at his feet, her face to the ground, and asked the question that reveals how deeply she felt her outsider status: "Why have I found such favor in your eyes that you notice me — a foreigner?" Boaz's answer reveals his character: "I've been told all about what you have done for your mother-in-law since the death of your husband — how you left your father and mother and your homeland and came to live with a people you did not know before. May the Lord repay you for what you have done. May you be richly rewarded by the Lord, the God of Israel, under whose wings you have come to take refuge." Boaz saw Ruth not as an ethnic category but as a woman of extraordinary character.

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(Rut ab a'igaru wediqa getsa nab meret atsegia'a kindey tselmat koynu kem zismi'a zigelits hito hatetet, "Silemintay ab aynkha kem'zi moges rekhebku — ba'idawit kelekhu astebhilkani?" Melsi Bo'az bahriyatu yigelits, "Dihri mot seb'aykhi nihhamatkhi zigebirikulu kulu tenegruni — abokhi'n adekhi'n adkhi'n gedifkhi mis qidim zeyfityom hizbi kitnebri kem zimets'ekhi. Igzi'abher nizigiberkyo yikhhaskhi. Ab tihiti akhnafu kitiqobi nab zimets'aekilu Amlak Asra'el Igzi'abher bihhabtam

*yishilimkhi." Bo'az niRut kem aletawi midib zeyikone kem filuy bahri zelata sebeiti'yu
ri'iywa.)*

Scene 14

[PICTURE: Ruth sitting among the workers at mealtime, eating roasted grain that Boaz personally offered her. She has more than enough. After the meal, Boaz quietly instructs his workers to deliberately leave extra grain for her to find. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

At mealtime, Boaz invited Ruth to eat with his workers — breaking social barriers by sharing his table with a foreign gleaner. He offered her roasted grain, and she ate until she was satisfied and had some left over. Then Boaz secretly instructed his men: "Let her gather among the sheaves and don't rebuke her. Rather, pull out some stalks from the bundles and leave them for her to pick up." Boaz's kindness was both public and private, both declared and hidden. He protected Ruth's dignity while providing abundantly for her. He gave her more than charity — he gave her honor.

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(Ab gize misah Bo'az niRut mis ayeytu kitbilile adema — niba'idawit arayit tawla'u bimikhifal mahberawi dobat seyru. Zitiqoriye sigem aqerebela kisab titsegib beli'et terefe'wun nebera. Dihri'u Bo'az bihbu'e niseb'utu azeze, "Ab mengo kumra kiti'ari hideguwa aytiginihwa. Are'a'iya kab timur gele intseyti sihhibkum kitirekhibbo gidifula." Lewhat Bo'az hizbawi'n bihitawi'n zite'aweji'n zitehab'a'n nebere. Bihabtam kitri'i kela kibri Rut halewe. Kab tsidigi nila'ili haba — kibri haba.)

Scene 15

[PICTURE: Ruth returning home to Naomi in the evening carrying an enormous amount of grain — far more than a typical gleaner would gather. Naomi's eyes widen with amazement and hope begins to flicker in her expression for the first time. Ruth pours out the grain before her. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

When Ruth returned home that evening, she carried about an ephah of barley — roughly 30 pounds, an astonishing amount for a single day of gleaning. Naomi was stunned. "Where did you glean today? Blessed be the man who took notice of you!" When Ruth told her it was Boaz, Naomi's voice trembled with recognition: "That man is our close relative; he is one of our kinsman-redeemers." For the first time since her losses, a spark of hope ignited in Naomi's eyes. The woman who called herself "bitter" began to sense that God had not abandoned her after all. Sometimes God's provision comes through faithful daily work, noticed by the right person at the right time.

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(Rut bimishet nab geza mis temeliset astat 30 pawnd sigem hiza neberet — nihanti me'alti araya zisidiniq bizhi. Na'omi tegereemet. "Lomi abey ikhi atsiddkhi? Zistebhaeleki seb burukh yikhun!") Rut Bo'az mkhwanu mis negereta dimtsi Na'omi bi'afilto teniqetiqete, "Iti seb'ay qerebana'yu, hade kab wahasitna'yu." Kab zisi'in nimejemertta qize ab a'dinti Na'omi tilqet tesfa teweli'e. Ita ri'isa "merir" zibelet sebeiti

Amlak bidihri kulu kem zeygedefa kithassib jemeret. Hade hade gize migbaz Amlak bi'imun me'altawi sirah yimits'i biqinu'e seb ab qinu'e gize zistebhale.)

Scene 16

[PICTURE: Naomi and Ruth sitting together by lamplight in their modest home, deep in conversation. Naomi leans forward with purpose and wisdom in her eyes, explaining a plan to Ruth. Ruth listens intently, trusting her mother-in-law's guidance. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Ruth gleaned faithfully through the entire barley and wheat harvests — weeks of steady, unglamorous work. Then Naomi, transformed from bitterness to strategic hope, said to Ruth: "My daughter, I must find a home for you, where you will be well provided for. Tonight Boaz will be winnowing barley on the threshing floor. Wash, put on perfume, and dress in your best clothes. Go down to the threshing floor, but don't let him know you are there until he has finished eating and drinking." Naomi was invoking the ancient custom of the kinsman-redeemer — a relative who could marry a widow to preserve the family line and restore the family's land.

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(Rut bimilu'e nay sigem'n sirinay'n atsid bi'imnet atsedet — semunaat nay qetsali kibri zeyiblu sirah. Dih'ru Na'omi kab miret nab stratejiyaw tesfa teqeyra niRut beleta, "Gwaley tsibuq kitrekhbilu geza kidileyelki'do ayigbe'anin? Lomi leyti Bo'az ab awdi midqas sigem ki'ali'yu. Tehhatsebi siti ti'um shito zitsbeqe kidawintikhi'wun libesi. Nab awdi midqas wiredi qin kisab beli'u'n setiyu'n ziwdi'e ab'u mhlawkhi

*aytifileq." Na'omi neti tintawi limad wahas — nisidrabeit selseleet nimi'iqab'n midri
sidrabeit nimimilas'n mebelet kimri'wo zikhil qereba zemed — titsuw'e neberet.)*

Scene 17

[PICTURE: The threshing floor at night under a starlit sky. Ruth approaches quietly and lies at the feet of sleeping Boaz. The scene is modest and dignified. Moonlight illuminates Ruth's nervous but determined expression as she makes this bold act of faith. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Ruth did everything Naomi instructed. When Boaz had eaten and drunk and was in good spirits, he lay down at the far end of the grain pile. Ruth approached quietly, uncovered his feet, and lay down there. At midnight, Boaz woke startled and found a woman lying at his feet. "Who are you?" he asked. "I am your servant Ruth," she said. "Spread the corner of your garment over me, since you are a kinsman-redeemer of our family." Ruth was not being seductive — she was making a legal and covenantal request, asking Boaz to fulfill his role as redeemer. It required extraordinary courage to make herself so vulnerable.

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(Rut Na'omi zi'azazeta kulu geberet. Bo'az beli'u setiyu tsibuq mis tesim'o ab chaf nay sigem kumra deqese. Rut bihid'at qeriba a'igaru qeli'a ab'u deqeset. Firqi leyti Bo'az tesenbidu teberabere ab a'igaru sebeiti deqisa rekebe. "Men ikhi?" hatete. "Ane qeredkha Rut've" belet. "Wahas sidrabetna sile zikhonka chaf kidanka ab li'ley

zirigihayo." Rut fetawit ayneberetin — higawi'n kidanawi'n hito tihatiit neberet Bo'az kem wahas gide'u kifitsim tihatiit neberet. Kind'u tetqa'iti ktigbir filuy tib'at hatete.)

Scene 18

[PICTURE: Boaz sitting up, speaking earnestly to Ruth in the dim moonlight on the threshing floor. His face shows deep respect, joy, and commitment. He promises to redeem her but explains there is a closer relative who has first right. His expression is honorable and protective. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Boaz's response reveals a man of deep integrity: "The Lord bless you, my daughter. This kindness is greater than that which you showed earlier — you have not run after the younger men, whether rich or poor. Don't be afraid. I will do for you all you ask. All the people of my town know that you are a woman of noble character." But then Boaz added a complication: there was a closer kinsman-redeemer who had first right. Boaz promised to settle the matter by morning. Notice — Boaz could have taken advantage of the situation. Instead, he chose to do things properly, honoring both the law and Ruth's dignity. Character is what you do when no one would judge you for doing less.

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(Melsi Bo'az amiq nitsuhinet zilewo seb yigelits; "Gwaley Igzi'abher yibarikhi. Izi lewhat kab'ti qedamay zi'abeye'yu — habtam wey dikha bizeyegedis dihri men'iseyat ayigoyekhin. Aytifrhi. Zihatetikyio kulu kigibirelki'ye. Kulu hizbi ketemay nay kibur bahri sebeiti mkhwankhi yifiliti." Gin Bo'az tsegem wesekhe; qedamay mesel zilewo ziqerebe wahas nebere. Bo'az nigiho neti quday kiwde'o qal atewe. Astebhil — Bo'az

*neti kunetat kimizimizo mikhe'ale. Ab kinid'u bigibu'e kigber meretse nihig'n nikibri
Rut'n akhbiru. Bahri malet zitehate bimigbar ziferrdeka seb mis zeyihilu tigibro'yu.)*

Scene 19

[PICTURE: Early morning at the city gate of Bethlehem. Boaz sits with ten elders in a semi-circle. The closer kinsman-redeemer sits across from him. Townspeople gather to witness the legal proceeding. The atmosphere is formal and decisive. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

The next morning, Boaz went to the town gate — the ancient equivalent of a courthouse — and gathered ten elders as witnesses. When the closer kinsman-redeemer passed by, Boaz called him over: "Naomi is selling the piece of land that belonged to our relative Elimelech. I thought I should bring the matter to your attention. If you will redeem it, do so. But if not, tell me, so I will know, for no one has the right to do it except you, and I am next in line." The closer relative agreed to buy the land — until Boaz added the crucial detail.

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(Nitsibihitu nigiho Bo'az nab dege ketema — nay tinti bet firdi — kede asirte abeyti kem miskrat akebe. Iti ziqerebe wahas mis halefe Bo'az tsew'o, "Na'omi nay zemedina Elimelekh zinebere qurats midri tisheyit ala. Izi guday kefiltieka hasebku. Kitiwahaso mis tideli giber. Gin inte zeyikonka nigereni kifiliti mikiniyatu bizeyikakha zikhil seb yelbon ane dima dihrিকা'ye." Iti ziqerebe zemed neta midri ki'idiga tesemsim'e — Bo'az wesani zirizir kisab ziwisikh.)

Scene 20

[PICTURE: The closer kinsman-redeemer removing his sandal and handing it to Boaz — the ancient legal sign of transferring rights. The elders nod in approval. Boaz receives the sandal with solemn dignity, his face showing quiet satisfaction that justice and love have aligned. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

On the day you buy the land from Naomi," Boaz continued, "you also acquire Ruth the Moabitess, the dead man's widow, in order to maintain the name of the dead with his property." At this, the closer relative backed away: "Then I cannot redeem it, because I might endanger my own estate." He removed his sandal — the legal sign of transferring the right of redemption — and gave it to Boaz. The other man saw Ruth as a liability, a financial risk, a complication. Boaz saw her as a person worth committing his life and resources to. How we view the vulnerable reveals our character far more than how we pursue success.

[illegible]

(Kab Na'omi neta midri ti'idig me'alti" Bo'az qetsele "niRut Mo'abawit nay murut zemed mebelet'wun tiwesda nay murut sim mis nibret'u nimi'iqab." Ab'zi iti ziqerebe zemed nefege, "Kiwahhaso ayikhiln mikiniyatu nay ba'iley nibret kesegagir yikhil." Chama'u awts'a — nay miwhasas mesel mitihilaf higawi miliklt — ni'Bo'az habo. Iti kal'e seb niRut kem tsegem qenzebawi hadeqa mitihilahk ri'ya. Bo'az kem hiwet'un

*habitu'n kiwefiyila zigba'a seb ri'ya. Nitetqa'iti bikemey kem niri'yom kab awet
bikemey kem nisi'ibo nila'ili bahriyatna yigelits.)*

Scene 21

[PICTURE: Boaz standing before the elders and townspeople, publicly declaring his redemption of Ruth. He holds Ruth's hand, presenting her as his wife. The elders raise their hands in blessing. The crowd celebrates with joy. Naomi watches from the background with tears of happiness. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Boaz announced to the elders and all the people: "Today you are witnesses that I have bought from Naomi all the property of Elimelech, Kilion, and Mahlon. I have also acquired Ruth the Moabite, Mahlon's widow, as my wife, in order to maintain the name of the dead with his property, so that his name will not disappear from among his family." The elders and townspeople responded with a beautiful blessing: "May the Lord make the woman who is coming into your home like Rachel and Leah, who together built up the house of Israel." A Moabite woman was being blessed with the same honor as Israel's matriarchs. God was already breaking down walls of ethnic division.

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(Bo'az ni'abeyt'n nikulu hizb'n aweie, "Lomi kulu nibret Elimelekh Kiliyon'n Mahhlon'n kab Na'omi kem zi'adegku miskrat ikhum. Rut Mo'abawit mebelet Mahhlon'wun kem sebeytey wesideya'ye nay murut sim mis nibret'u nimi'iqab simu kab sidrabetu keyitefie." Itom abeyt'n ketemwiyan'n bitsibuq bereket melesu, "Nab gezakha timits'e zela sebeiti kem Rahel'n Liya'n nibet Asra'el bihade zihanetsa Igzi'abher yigibera."

*Mo'abawit sebeiti kem adetat Asra'el hade aynet kibri tibarekh neberet. Amlak diro
nay alet mifillay mendi q yiferis nebere.)*

Scene 22

[PICTURE: A joyful wedding celebration — Ruth and Boaz standing together under a canopy, surrounded by celebrating townspeople. Naomi stands proudly beside them, no longer bitter but radiant with joy. Flowers, music, and colorful fabrics fill the scene. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

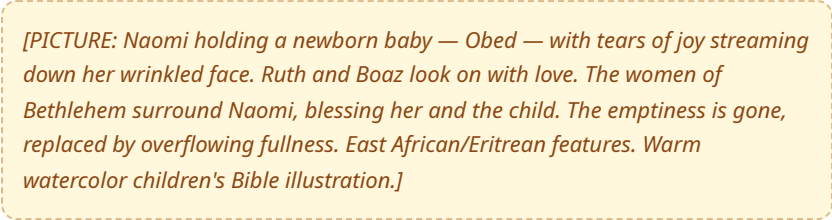
Ruth and Boaz married. Consider the journey: a foreign widow gleaning in fields for survival became the wife of one of Bethlehem's most prominent men. But this was not a rags-to-riches fairy tale — it was the fruit of character meeting character, faithfulness meeting faithfulness, and God weaving together a story that no human could have orchestrated. Ruth's loyalty to Naomi led her to Bethlehem. Her work ethic led her to Boaz's field. Her character earned Boaz's respect. And Boaz's integrity made him worthy of the trust she placed in him. Every small, faithful act was a thread in God's tapestry.

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(Rut'n Bo'az'n temer'awu. Neti gu'izo hiseb; nidihinnet ab grat ti'ari zineberet ba'idawit mebelet nay Betlehem kab zile'alu sebat hade sebeiti konet. Gin izi kab dikhnet nab habti nay tewas'o tsuwtsway ayineberen — bahri mis bahri ta'amannet mis ta'amannet ziterakebe Amlak dima manim seb ki'ali zeymikhe'ale zanta zifetele fire nebere. Ta'amannet Rut ni'Na'omi nab Betlehem weseda. Nay sirah tsihaf miqbara nab grat Bo'az weseda. Bahriya akhibrot Bo'az rekhebet. Nitsuhnet Bo'az

dima ni'ata zihabeto miti'immman biqu'e gebero. Nefsi wekef ni'us amin tegbar ab hats Amlak nay hari sedyā nebere.)

Scene 23



God blessed Ruth and Boaz with a son — Obed. But the text focuses not on Ruth but on Naomi, as the women of Bethlehem placed the baby in her arms and proclaimed: "Naomi has a son! Praise be to the Lord, who this day has not left you without a guardian-redeemer. Your daughter-in-law, who loves you and who is better to you than seven sons, has given him birth." The woman who returned empty now overflowed. The woman who said God made her life bitter now cradled the proof of His faithfulness. Naomi's emptiness became fullness — not because her circumstances changed overnight, but because God worked patiently through ordinary faithfulness over time.

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(Amlak niRut'n Bo'az'n biwedi — Obed — barekkom. Gin iti tsihuf ab Rut zeyikone ab Na'omi'yu zetekur anisti Betlehem neti hitsan ab ida mis aqemetha'o aweja, "Na'omi wedi alewa! Lomi bizey halawi-wahas zeygidifekhi ni'Igzi'abher misigana yikhun. Seb'utkhi zimutu nikibid gega tiray ayikonettin ni'akhi tifetiwekhi kab shew'ate

awedat tibeltseekhi sebeiti welidato'ya." Ita tirihihi temelisa zineberet hiji hilif ila temle'at. Ita Amlak hiweta merir geyruwa zibelet hiji nay imnet'u meregazhe'tsi haqufa neberet. Tirihinet Na'omi mili'at kone — kunetata bihanti leyti sile ziteqeyere zeyikone Amlak bigize bitera ta'amannet bitigisti sile zisirhe.)

zanta'u niwishitenyatat tiray ayikonen. Alem netom zigelifom nisu bihassab yihawsom. Nimengist'u bi'aminat yihanitso bifiluyat zeyikone. Sim Rut ab selseleet alet Yesus ab Mate'os mi'iraf 1 yirekeb — nay Amlak fiqri deqi seb ziteklwo kulu dob kem zisegir qewami zekir.)

Scene 25

[PICTURE: A powerful closing image — Ruth as a young Moabite woman on one side and Ruth as a respected matriarch on the other, connected by a golden thread of faithfulness. Between them, images of her journey: the road from Moab, the barley field, Boaz's kindness, baby Obed. Above, God's hand weaves it all together. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Ruth's story speaks to every person who has ever felt like an outsider — too different, too foreign, too broken to belong in God's story. It tells us that loyalty and love can transcend cultural and ethnic boundaries. It demonstrates that God deliberately includes outsiders in His plan. It proves that faithfulness in small, daily acts of service — gleaning in a field, caring for a grieving mother-in-law, doing humble work with excellence — leads to extraordinary outcomes that only God could orchestrate. It shows that God redeems empty seasons and transforms loss into legacy. And it reminds us that true love is not merely emotion — it is sacrificial commitment that perseveres when there is no visible reward. Be faithful where you are. Love who is in front of you. Trust God with the story He is writing.

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(Zanta Rut nikulu wetsa'itenya koyu zitesim'o seb tizareb — azyu filuy, azyu ba'idawi ab zanta Amlak nimiti'ittaw azyu zitesebere. Ta'amannet'n fiqir'n nay bahil'n alet'n dobat ksegir kem zikhil tinegrena. Amlak bihasab niwetsa'itenyat ab medebu kem zihawis teri'i. Ab ni'usat me'altawi ageligilot — ab grat mi'iray nihazanit hamat mihbihab tihhut sirah bibilutsnet misirah — Amlak tiray ki'ali zikhil filuy wits'it kem zimerih teregagits. Amlak tirhu gizeyat kem ziwahhas si'inet nab wirsha kem ziqyir teri'i. Haqenya fiqri simi'it tiray zeyikone — zir'e asbi mis zeyihilu zitsen'e nay meswa'iti qal kidan mkhwanu tezekakhirena. Ab zelekha amin kun. Ab qidmekha zelo fiqer. Amlak zitsihifo zelo zanta aminikayo.)

The Moral of the Story

Loyalty and love can transcend cultural and ethnic boundaries — God's family has no borders. God deliberately includes outsiders in His story, proving that belonging is not about heritage but about faithfulness. Small, daily acts of service — done with humility and excellence — lead to extraordinary outcomes that only God can orchestrate. God redeems empty seasons and transforms loss into legacy; no chapter of suffering is the final chapter. True love is not merely emotion; it is sacrificial commitment that perseveres when there is no visible reward, choosing another's good above your own comfort.

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*(Ta'amannet'n fiqir'n nay bahil'n alet'n dobat kisegir yikhil — sidrabiet Amlak
dob yebilan. Amlak bihassab niwetsa'itenyatat ab zanta'u yihawis miti'ittaw
biza'iba wirsha zeyikone biza'iba ta'amannet mkhwanu yiregagits. Ni'usat
me'altawi ageligilot — bitihitina'n bilutsnet'n zitegebere — Amlak tiray ki'ali
zikhil filuy wits'it yimerih. Amlak tirhu gizayat yiwahhas si'innet nab wirsha
yiqyir; zikhone mi'iraf siqay nay meweda'eta mi'iraf ayikonen. Haqenya fiqri
simi'it tiray ayikonen — zir'e asbi mis zeyihilu zitsen'e ri'iskha michitkha ab
li'li nay kal'ot senay zimrits nay meswa'iti qal kidan'yu.)*



Discussion Questions / 討論問題

1. Ruth left everything familiar — her homeland, culture, religion, and family — to follow Naomi into an uncertain future. Have you ever had to leave something comfortable behind to do the right thing? What made it difficult, and what gave you the courage to move forward?

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2. Naomi was brutally honest about her pain — she told God and others that her life was bitter. Do you think it's okay to be angry or honest with God about suffering? How does Naomi's story show that expressing pain and having faith are not opposites?

2. **אם אדם נשבע בשבועה שאינו יעשה מעשה מסוים, האם הוא חייב לשמור על שבועתו?** **אם לא, מדוע?**

3. Ruth didn't wait for rescue — she immediately went to work in the fields, doing humble labor to provide for herself and Naomi. How does Ruth's example challenge the idea that faithfulness means passively waiting for God to act? What does it look like to be both trusting God and taking initiative?

[illegible]

4. Boaz used his wealth and position to protect and provide for Ruth rather than exploit her vulnerability. In your life, how can you use whatever privilege or advantage you have to uplift others rather than benefit only yourself? What does it mean to be a "kinsman-redeemer" in today's world?

[illegible]

5. God placed Ruth — a Moabite foreigner — directly in the genealogy of Jesus. What does this tell us about who God includes in His story? Are there people in your community whom others consider "outsiders" that God might be calling you to welcome, befriend, or stand with?

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Prayer / 祈禱

Lord God, You are the great Redeemer who turns emptiness into fullness and transforms loss into legacy. Thank You for the story of Ruth — for showing us that Your love knows no borders, Your family has no walls, and Your plan includes those the world overlooks. Give us Ruth's courage to leave comfort behind and follow love into the unknown. Give us Boaz's character to use our strength to protect the vulnerable rather than exploit them. Teach us that faithfulness in small, ordinary moments is the foundation for extraordinary things we cannot yet see. When we feel like outsiders — too different, too broken, too far gone — remind us that You specialize in writing the marginalized into the center of Your story. We trust You to redeem our empty seasons.

In Jesus' name, Amen.

[illegible]

*(Goyta Amlak niskha ikha tirihinet nab mili'at ziqyir si'inet nab wirsha zilwit
abi wahas. Nizanta Rut nemsgin — fiqirka dob kem zeyiblu sidrabetkha
mendi q kem zeyibla medebka alem zeyri'yom kem zihawis sile zer'akana.
Nay Rut tib'at michiit gedifka fiqri nab zeyfiluit nimis'ab habena. Nay Bo'az*

bahri haylina nitetqa'iti nimihilaw nimtiq'am zeyikone nimizmaz habena. Ab ni'usat tera himot ta'amannet gena kinri'yo nizeynikhil filuy negeraat seret mkhwanu miharena. Wetsa'itenyatat koynu mis zismi'ana — azyu filuy azyu zitesebere azyu zirehaaqe — nigelelitenyatat nab ma'ikel zantakha mitsihaf ki'ilakha mkhwanu azekakhirena. Tirhu gizeyatna kitiwahhas ni'amineka ina. Bisim Yesus Amen.)

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories

Book 47 of 60

Thank you for reading! We pray this story inspires you to embrace radical loyalty, to love across boundaries, and to trust that God weaves every act of faithfulness into a story greater than you can imagine.

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